

Current Affairs + Static GK: Complete Class Notes

Session date: **Monday, 21 September 2026** | Topics: Greenland & NATO, Asian Games 2026, Exercises, Mission Mausam, Karnataka, Awards, Rivers, Appointments & Static GK | Includes Quick Revision and all MCQs

Class overview & announcements

- Today's date is 21 (Monday). All important current affairs up to this morning are covered, chiefly the **Asian Games** and **Greenland** news.
- UP PET previous-year papers:** new papers have been held in **Karnataka, Jammu & Kashmir** and **Rajasthan**. The three papers will be solved over the **next three days** (tomorrow, day after, and the day after that).
- New 11:00 AM session (Mon-Fri, 5 days):** Static GK – the most repeated questions, some PYQs, and questions from different exams (useful for CHSL, GD, MTS). Today is lecture 1. Class PDF is on Telegram.
- Paid batch (with book): messages go out today; if a batch is not active, message on Telegram with your contact number after 12:00 PM (the team arrives at 11:00). Attend every class so you do not miss updates.
- Mindset:** Everyone works hard – even a donkey does. What matters is direction and ideology: know what you are preparing for, then work hard. Luck is ~1% and works only when you work for yourself.

1. Greenland Is Not For Sale - NATO welcomes US-Denmark-Greenland deal

- News:** NATO welcomed an agreement under which the **USA signs a defence deal with Greenland and Denmark**. The deal says Greenland will be “taken care of” by the US.
- Background:** For a long time Donald Trump had been saying “I want Greenland”. The US now argues that the location is extremely important, ships of various countries roam nearby and Greenland faces a threat, so a defence agreement is proposed.
- Why the US wants it (class analysis):** Greenland has the most glaciers/ice and resources the US needs to build its “**Golden Dome**”, modelled on Israel's **Iron Dome** (an air-defence system that destroys incoming missiles in the air so they do not fall on Israel). Nobody offers such help without self-interest.

Greenland	World's largest island ; lies between the Arctic Ocean and Atlantic Ocean ; north-east of North America, towards Europe.
Water bodies	Davis Strait, Beaufort Sea, Labrador Sea (as named in class). Neighbour: Iceland .
Governance	Under Denmark's governance, but has its own Prime Minister post – James Frederick as named in class (actual name: Jens-Frederik Nielsen†).
Other facts	Capital Nuuk ; igloos; Eskimo (Inuit) tribe; has the most ice/glaciers.
NATO	HQ Brussels ; led by the USA ; 32 member countries; formed against Russia .
Russia-Ukraine	Many European countries fear a Russian attack “at any cost”; Russia says it has no such plan. Ukraine attacked Russia with drones ; Russia hit back. The war continues.

2. Asian Games 2026 (Aichi-Nagoya, Japan)

Edition / venue	20th Asian Games; hosted at Aichi-Nagoya, Japan . All Asian countries participate. First-ever edition: 1951, New Delhi . Games end next month.
New sports (5)	Taekwondo (as taught), Padel, Teqball, Surfing and Martial arts (MMA) – included for the first time.
Mascot	Hanuhon† (as heard in class).
Flag bearers	Manu Bhaker and originally Tajinder† (kit delayed, could not take part). Replaced by Pawan (Kabaddi player) – the flag-bearer change happened at the opening ceremony .

Shooting - India's first two medals (both Silver)

- Team silver - 10 m Air Rifle:** **Elavenil Valarivan** (spelt “Ellavenil” in audio), **Sonam** and **Vidarsha†** together won silver.
- Individual silver - 10 m Air Rifle:** Elavenil Valarivan also won an individual silver in the same event – so two silvers came in shooting, one in the team and one individual.
- Manu Bhaker: will be discussed if she finishes in the top three.

MMA (Martial arts) - a lesson in luck and discipline

- India sent two MMA athletes. One was due to fight but, like **Vinesh Phogat**, had a last-night weight problem (rapid weight cut), felt dizzy and was **ruled out of the event**. The teacher's message: 99% hard work + 1% luck, and luck stands by you only when you stand by yourself.
- Tomorrow's class:** the first time an Indian **woman has won a medal in martial arts** (article due today).

Cricket (T20 format) at the Asian Games

- India (women) are in the **final**; **semi-final: India vs Bangladesh**. An India vs Japan match was also mentioned.
- Smriti Mandhana** – highest run-scorer in women's T20I history: **4,759** runs (No. 1); she also has T20 centuries. **No. 2: Suzie Bates - 4,758 runs**.
- Shafali Verma** – scored a **century (100 runs) in 49 balls**, becoming the **first player to score a century at the Asian Games**.

- Teacher's view: India will win both the men's and women's gold. Also: R. Madhavan's son is swimming for India at these Games.

3. Exercise Eager Lion 2026 (US-Jordan)

- Question asked: Exercise "Eagle Line" 2026 (US-hosted, with **CENTCOM**) – with which country? **Answer: Jordan**. The correct name is **Eager Lion**, not Eagle.
- 12th edition**; the first edition was held in **2010**. Hosted in **Colorado, USA**† as per class. Purpose: to strengthen defence cooperation.

Jordan	In Middle East Asia ; capital Amman ; shares a border with Israel ; River Jordan flows here; recently declared leprosy-free .
India-USA exercises	Yudh Abhyas (most important) • Tiger Triumph ("Tiger Tru") • Red Flag • Cope India • Malabar .

4. Mission Mausam - Doppler Weather Radar installed at Sambalpur (Odisha)

- Question:** India installed a weather-observation radar system – **Doppler Weather Radar (DWR)**. Asked in UP PET.

Mission Mausam	Launched in 2024 ; Rs 2,000 crore investment for the next 2 years ; 81 radar installations to be done in total.
Purpose	Weather reports: where a cyclone is coming, where it may rain, weather conditions, where lightning will flash/strike – signals for early warning.
Odisha radars	1st: Paradip Port • 2nd: Gopalpur • 3rd: Sambalpur (new). Sambalpur was also linked to Nuakhai festival.
Ministry / People	Ministry of Earth Sciences ; Minister Dr Jitendra Singh ; Odisha CM Mohan Charan Majhi .
Regulator	IMD (India Meteorological Department) regulates; formed 1875 ; works with the Government of India .

5. Karnataka - Tulu as second administrative language, Marine Policy, CM change

- Question:** Tulu has been added as the **second administrative language** in **Karnataka**. **Kannada** is the first. Announced at **Bengaluru** by CM **D. K. Shivakumar** at a conference. It will be used for administrative purposes, especially in **Dakshina Kannada** and **Udupi**.
- Tulu** is a **Dravidian language** (most important point). Kannada was first considered an official language in **1963**; Tulu was recognised about **18 years** later (as stated in class).
- Renaming:** **Dakshina Kannada** district to get a new name (audio unclear, likely "Mangaluru"†).
- Marine Policy** (2026-2031): promotes universities/colleges teaching marine subjects such as **fisheries**; focus on **marine biotechnology**.
- CM rotation:** Siddaramaiah was CM for the first 2.5 years; **D. K. Shivakumar** now takes over for the next 2.5 years – two CMs in one term.
- Karnataka Day: 1 November** (formerly **Mysore**). Languages: Karnataka-Kannada; Goa-Konkani; Tamil Nadu-Tamil; Telangana/Andhra-Telugu; Kerala-Malayalam ("Keralam").

6. Alfred Cooke (died 18 September, aged 87) - 1965 War, Vir Chakra

- Alfred Tyrone Cooke** (heard as "Alfred Trayan Cook"†), an **IAF** officer, died on **18 September in Delhi** aged **87**. Awarded the **Vir Chakra** for the **1965 India-Pakistan War**; he belonged to **No. 14 Squadron "Bulls"**.
- Background:** India and Pakistan were formed in 1947. In West Bengal, some parts went to East Pakistan, but a place remained disputed: **Kalaikunda** (West Bengal). The 1965 war followed and the fighting took place here.
- He flew a **Hawker Hunter** alone against **six Pakistani Sabre jets**; he shot down one Sabre, which fell and took another aircraft down with it. (Tip: watch the series *Safed Sagar* on the Kargil-era air force.)

Gallantry order	1. Param Vir Chakra → 2. Maha Vir Chakra → 3. Vir Chakra (third-highest). Vir Chakra started in 1950 .
Recent awards	Shubhanshu Shukla (went to space with NASA) → Ashok Chakra . Abhinandan Varthaman → Vir Chakra (the teacher corrected the class after students swapped them).

7. Fitzroy River - Brisbane 2032 Olympics & Paralympics

- Olympic cycle:** Paris 2024 (Manu Bhaker won **two Bronze medals** in one Games) → **Los Angeles 2028** → **Brisbane 2032** (Queensland, Australia) → **2036 possibly India** (expected, not confirmed).
- Two events** of the 2032 Games (water events: **rowing** and **canoeing**) will be held on the **Fitzroy River**, Queensland (near **Rockhampton**†). Queensland's capital: **Brisbane**.

River facts	Famous for saltwater crocodiles . Formed by the confluence of the Dawson and Mackenzie rivers. Rises in the Great Dividing Range ; forms a delta on the Coral Sea (Pacific Ocean). Port on its bank: Alma Port (not "Armapur").
Australia rivers	Murray = Australia's major river; Darling = its tributary. (Class also noted that Odisha has 5 crocodile varieties†.)

8. Swedish Business Climate Survey - India No. 1

- **India ranks 1st** among **41 countries** in the survey by the **Swedish Chamber of Commerce in India** (data first released in **2020**). **No. 2: Ireland; No. 3: Vietnam**.
- Related: WEF **Gender Gap Report** - India at **131** (same as last year). The **Ease of Doing Business** report was issued by the **World Bank** and is **no longer published**.

9. ISSF Junior World Cup (Shooting) - India wins Gold

- It is the **second event** of the ISSF junior season; the first was held in **Egypt** where India won **5 gold** and **16 medals** in all. This event was held in **Italy** (venue heard as "Forpeto"†).
- **Gold in Men's Trap (shotgun):** a **15-year-old** - **Yugan Shaktivel Muthukumar†**. **Women's Trap Bronze: Shabeera Harish†**. The ISSF **Final** is in **December**.

10. Appointments & International Organisations

- **Dilip Sanghani** (Chairman, **IFFCO** - an Indian fertiliser cooperative; not "Singhanian") appointed **Director-at-Large** of the **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)** for **2026-2030**. The ICA is an alliance/group formed in **1895**, HQ **London** as taught†. Its head: **Dr Ariel Guarco** (Argentina).
- Other London-HQ bodies: **World Gold Council** and **Amnesty International**.
- **Hansraj Singh Verma** appointed India's next **Ambassador to Cuba**. Cuba: Caribbean country, "**Sugar Bowl of the World**", capital **Havana**.

11. Rivers, Static GK & PYQs discussed

- **Kosi = "Sorrow of Bihar"**. **Gandak (= Narayani)** water level has risen - water coming from Nepal. Ganga originates from **Gangotri Glacier**.
- **Largest state by area: Rajasthan** (UP is 4th by area, 1st by population; **Bihar** 1st by density). **Revolt of 1857** began at **Meerut** (immediate cause: **Mangal Pandey**; slogan "Maro Firangiyo ko"). **RBI** formed in **1935**.
- **Fundamental Rights:** Part **III** (Part I: Union & Territory; II: Citizenship; IV: DPSP); borrowed from the **USA**. **Atmosphere:** Nitrogen ~78%, Oxygen ~21%. **Cotton:** black soil. **Maurya Empire founder:** Chandragupta Maurya.
- **History PYQs:** Battle of Buxar **1764** (Plassey 1757; Regulating Act 1773). **Toda tribe** - Nilgiri Hills (Tamil Nadu). **Permanent Settlement** in Bengal - **Cornwallis** (Curzon: Partition of Bengal 1905; Dalhousie: Doctrine of Lapse).

12. Quick Revision - one-line facts

Largest state by area	Rajasthan (UP 4th)	IMD formed	1875
Highest density	Bihar	Tulu	2nd admin language, Karnataka; Dravidian
1857 Revolt began	Meerut	Karnataka CM (new)	D. K. Shivakumar
NATO HQ / members	Brussels / 32	Kosi / Gandak	Sorrow of Bihar / Narayani
Greenland capital	Nuuk (Denmark)	Ganga source	Gangotri Glacier
Golden Dome	USA missile shield (like Iron Dome)	RBI formed	1935
20th Asian Games	Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	Fitzroy River	Queensland; Dawson + Mackenzie
1st Asian Games	1951, New Delhi	2032 Olympics	Brisbane, Australia
Team silver (10m rifle)	Elavenil, Sonam, Vidarsha	Swedish survey	India 1st of 41; Ireland 2; Vietnam 3
Top T20I runs (women)	Smriti Mandhana 4,759	Vir Chakra	3rd highest; started 1950
Shafali Verma	100 off 49 balls; 1st Asian Games ton	Ashok Chakra (recent)	Shubhanshu Shukla
Eager Lion 2026	US-Jordan; 12th; first 2010	ICA	1895; London; Sanghani 2026-30
Jordan capital	Amman (leprosy-free)	Cuba	Havana; Hansraj Singh Verma
Mission Mausam	2024; Rs 2,000 cr; 81 DWR	Buxar	1764
3rd Odisha DWR	Sambalpur (Paradip, Gopalpur first)	Permanent Settlement	Cornwallis

MCQ Practice - All questions from today's Current Affairs class

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PART A - Questions asked in class (options not read aloud were added)

- Q1. Which is the largest Indian state by area?**
(A) Uttar Pradesh (B) Rajasthan (C) Madhya Pradesh (D) Maharashtra
✓ Ans: (B) **Rajasthan** - Rajasthan. UP is 4th by area, 1st by population; Bihar is 1st by density.
- Q2. The Revolt of 1857 first began at:**
(A) Delhi (B) Kanpur (C) Meerut (D) Jhansi
✓ Ans: (C) **Meerut** - Meerut; immediate cause - Mangal Pandey.
- Q3. Elavenil Valarivan won Asian Games silver in:**
(A) 10 m Air Pistol (B) 10 m Air Rifle (C) 25 m Pistol (D) Trap
✓ Ans: (B) **10 m Air Rifle** - Team and individual silver, both in 10 m Air Rifle.
- Q4. Fundamental Rights are in which Part of the Constitution?**
(A) Part I (B) Part II (C) Part III (D) Part IV
✓ Ans: (C) **Part III** - Part III (Part IV = DPSP).
- Q5. Which gas has the highest share in the atmosphere?**
(A) Oxygen (B) Nitrogen (C) Argon (D) Carbon dioxide
✓ Ans: (B) **Nitrogen** - Nitrogen ~78%; Oxygen ~21%.
- Q6. Exercise Eager Lion 2026 (US, CENTCOM) was with which country?**
(A) Israel (B) Egypt (C) Jordan (D) Saudi Arabia
✓ Ans: (C) **Jordan** - Jordan; 12th edition, first held 2010.
- Q7. The Ganga originates from which glacier?**
(A) Siachen (B) Gangotri (C) Zemu (D) Pindari
✓ Ans: (B) **Gangotri** - Gangotri Glacier.
- Q8. The Reserve Bank of India was formed in:**
(A) 1925 (B) 1935 (C) 1947 (D) 1949
✓ Ans: (B) **1935** - 1935.
- Q9. Which weather-observation radar system was newly installed at Sambalpur (Odisha)?**
(A) Doppler Weather Radar (B) Wind Profiler (C) Weather Balloon (D) Cloud Lidar
✓ Ans: (A) **Doppler Weather Radar** - Doppler Weather Radar under Mission Mausam (3rd in Odisha).
- Q10. Fundamental Rights were borrowed from:**
(A) UK (B) USA (C) Ireland (D) Canada
✓ Ans: (B) **USA** - USA.
- Q11. Which river is known as the "Sorrow of Bihar"?**
(A) Gandak (B) Kosi (C) Son (D) Ghaghara
✓ Ans: (B) **Kosi** - Kosi; Gandak = Narayani.
- Q12. Dilip Sanghani (IFFCO) was appointed for 2026-30 to which body?**
(A) International Cooperative Alliance (B) ILO (C) WTO (D) IMF
✓ Ans: (A) **International Cooperative Alliance** - ICA (formed 1895); Director-at-Large.
- Q13. Which soil is best for cotton?**
(A) Alluvial (B) Black (C) Red (D) Laterite
✓ Ans: (B) **Black** - Black (regur) soil.
- Q14. Who founded the Maurya Empire?**
(A) Ashoka (B) Bindusara (C) Chandragupta Maurya (D) Chanakya
✓ Ans: (C) **Chandragupta Maurya** - Chandragupta Maurya.
- Q15. Tulu was added as second administrative language in:**
(A) Kerala (B) Karnataka (C) Tamil Nadu (D) Goa
✓ Ans: (B) **Karnataka** - Karnataka (Kannada first); Tulu is Dravidian.
- Q16. The Battle of Buxar was fought in:**
(A) 1761 (B) 1764 (C) 1772 (D) 1757
✓ Ans: (B) **1764** - 1764 (Plassey = 1757; Regulating Act = 1773).
- Q17. The Toda tribe is found chiefly in:**
(A) Nilgiri Hills (B) Aravalli Hills (C) Garo Hills (D) Western Ghats (north)
✓ Ans: (A) **Nilgiri Hills**, Tamil Nadu.
- Q18. Who introduced the Permanent Settlement in Bengal?**
(A) Curzon (B) Dalhousie (C) Wellesley (D) Cornwallis
✓ Ans: (D) **Cornwallis** - Cornwallis (Curzon: Partition 1905; Dalhousie: Lapse).
- Q19. Alfred Cooke (died 18 Sept, aged 87), a 1965-war hero, was honoured with:**
(A) Ashok Chakra (B) Maha Vir Chakra (C) Vir Chakra (D) Param Vir Chakra
✓ Ans: (C) **Vir Chakra** - Vir Chakra; No. 14 Sqn "Bulls", Hawker Hunter.
- Q20. The Fitzroy River (2032 Olympics rowing/canoeing) is in:**
(A) Queensland (B) New South Wales (C) Victoria (D) Tasmania
✓ Ans: (A) **Queensland** - Queensland; formed by Dawson + Mackenzie.
- Q21. Which country ranks No. 1 in the Swedish Business Climate Survey?**
(A) Ireland (B) Vietnam (C) India (D) Germany
✓ Ans: (C) **India** - India; 41 countries; Ireland 2nd, Vietnam 3rd.

Q22. 15-year-old gold in Men's Trap, ISSF Junior World Cup:
(A) Yugan Shaktivel Muthukumar (B) Vedaant Madhavan (C) Shabeera Harish (D) Sonam
✓ Ans: (A) **Yugan Shaktivel Muthukumar** - Yugant (Women's bronze: Shabeera Harisht).

Q23. Hansraj Singh Verma is India's new Ambassador to:
(A) Cuba (B) Chile (C) Peru (D) Cyprus
✓ Ans: (A) **Cuba** - Cuba; capital Havana.

Q24. Who received the Ashok Chakra recently (as per class)?
(A) Abhinandan Varthaman (B) Shubhanshu Shukla (C) Alfred Cooke (D) Tajinder
✓ Ans: (B) **Shubhanshu Shukla** - Shukla → Ashok Chakra; Abhinandan → Vir Chakra.

PART B - Practice MCQs from facts taught in class

Q25. Greenland is an autonomous part of which country?
(A) USA (B) Iceland (C) Denmark (D) Norway
✓ Ans: (C) **Denmark** - Denmark; capital Nuuk.

Q26. "Golden Dome" is planned by:
(A) Israel (B) USA (C) Russia (D) China
✓ Ans: (B) **USA** - USA (modelled on Israel's Iron Dome).

Q27. NATO headquarters is at:
(A) London (B) Paris (C) Brussels (D) Geneva
✓ Ans: (C) **Brussels** - Brussels; 32 members.

Q28. Mission Mausam (2024) has how many radar installations?
(A) 41 (B) 81 (C) 32 (D) 20
✓ Ans: (B) **81** - 81; Rs 2,000 crore.

Q29. The India Meteorological Department was formed in:
(A) 1875 (B) 1885 (C) 1935 (D) 1950
✓ Ans: (A) **1875** - 1875.

Q30. India's rank in the Gender Gap Report (as per class):
(A) 101 (B) 118 (C) 131 (D) 145
✓ Ans: (C) **131** - 131 (same as last year).

Q31. The Ease of Doing Business report was published by:
(A) IMF (B) World Bank (C) WEF (D) UNDP
✓ Ans: (B) **World Bank** - World Bank; now discontinued.

Q32. Highest run-scorer in women's T20Is:
(A) Suzie Bates (B) Smriti Mandhana (C) Shafali Verma (D) Harmanpreet Kaur
✓ Ans: (B) **Smriti Mandhana** - Mandhana 4,759; Bates 4,758.

Q33. Shafali Verma's Asian Games century came off:
(A) 39 balls (B) 49 balls (C) 59 balls (D) 69 balls
✓ Ans: (B) **49 balls** - 49 balls; first Asian Games ton.

Q34. The first Asian Games (1951) were held in:
(A) Tokyo (B) Manila (C) New Delhi (D) Bangkok
✓ Ans: (C) **New Delhi** - New Delhi.

Q35. Host of the 2032 Olympics:
(A) Los Angeles (B) Brisbane (C) Paris (D) Mumbai
✓ Ans: (B) **Brisbane** - Brisbane (LA hosts 2028).

Q36. Capital of Cuba ("Sugar Bowl of the World"):
(A) Havana (B) Amman (C) Nuuk (D) Lima
✓ Ans: (A) **Havana** - Havana.

Q37. Capital of Jordan:
(A) Amman (B) Beirut (C) Doha (D) Cairo
✓ Ans: (A) **Amman** - Amman; also leprosy-free.

Q38. Karnataka Day (Rajyotsava) is celebrated on:
(A) 1 Jan (B) 1 Nov (C) 26 Jan (D) 15 Aug
✓ Ans: (B) **1 Nov** - 1 November; earlier Mysore.

Q39. World Gold Council and Amnesty International are HQ'd in:
(A) London (B) Geneva (C) New York (D) Paris
✓ Ans: (A) **London** - London.

Q40. Gandak river is also called:
(A) Kosi (B) Narayani (C) Sarayu (D) Gomti
✓ Ans: (B) **Narayani** - Narayani.

Q41. Kalaikunda, linked to the 1965 war story, is in:
(A) Punjab (B) West Bengal (C) Rajasthan (D) Assam
✓ Ans: (B) **West Bengal** - West Bengal.

Q42. Order of gallantry awards (highest first):
(A) PVC, MVC, Vrc (B) MVC, PVC, Vrc (C) Vrc, MVC, PVC (D) AC, PVC, MVC
✓ Ans: (A) **PVC, MVC, Vrc** - Param Vir → Maha Vir → Vir Chakra.